THE RANGER ARTS

A player guide • D&D 2024 / 5.5e • Arts of ranks 1–3

“The woods teach their own lessons. Some hunters learn more than they should.”

What is a Ranger?

In Blackhearts, magic is rare and mistrusted. Rangers do not cast spells in the usual sense. Their Ranger Arts are exceptional techniques, hardened instincts, fieldcraft, and—at their most unsettling—abilities that defy ordinary explanation. A Ranger may not know why an Art works, and need not call it magic.

Using Ranger Arts

• Ranger Arts replace the Ranger spells listed in this guide. You prepare Arts using your normal 2024 Ranger prepared-spell allowance and expend normal Ranger spell slots to use them.

• An Art keeps the original spell’s action, range, duration, concentration, saving throw, and scaling unless its description below says otherwise. “Concentration” is called Focus, but uses the same rules.

• Arts have no spellcasting components. Physical Arts still require appropriate tools, weapons, supplies, terrain, or sensory access as described.

• Arts are not spells: Detect Magic, Counterspell, Dispel Magic, and Antimagic Field do not affect them. Features triggered by casting a spell are not triggered by an Art.

• You cannot prepare a Ranger spell that is not on this approved list unless the Game Master explicitly allows it. Subclass spells and magical subclass features are reviewed separately.

Rank 1 Arts

Ranger Art	Based on	What it looks like
Perimeter Watch	Alarm	Set subtle warning lines and alarms around a camp.
Beast Tamer	Animal Friendship	Calm a beast through scent, posture, and practiced signals.
Field Medicine	Cure Wounds	Treat wounds with a healer’s kit and expert care.
Toxicologist	Detect Poison and Disease	Identify poison or illness through close examination.
Binding Strike	Ensnaring Strike	Trap a target with a snare or specialized projectile.
Scattershot	Hail of Thorns	Strike nearby foes with a prepared scattering projectile.
Predator’s Focus	Hunter’s Mark	Read and exploit a quarry’s weaknesses.

Explosive Leap	Jump	Perform a near-impossible athletic leap.
Endurance Training	Longstrider	Move with tireless, economical strides.
Beast Whisperer	Speak with Animals	Exchange meaning through uncanny animal understanding.

Rank 1 special rules

Perimeter Watch requires 10 minutes to install and uses a physical alarm, not a telepathic message. Field Medicine requires touch and one use of a healer's kit; it cannot treat Constructs or Undead. Binding Strike requires a weapon or trap implement. Scattershot requires a ranged weapon and prepared ammunition. Beast Whisperer does not make animals speak human languages.

Rank 2 Arts

Ranger Art	Based on	What it looks like
Battle Hardened	Aid	Prepare companions to withstand greater punishment.
Beast Courier	Animal Messenger	Direct a real animal to carry a simple message.
Beast Bond	Beast Sense	Share the senses of a bonded animal.
Night Eyes	Darkvision	See in darkness through uncanny sensory adaptation.
Peak Conditioning	Enhance Ability	Enter a state of exceptional physical or mental performance.
Danger Sense	Find Traps	Notice subtle evidence of concealed hazards.
Wilderness Medicine	Lesser Restoration	Treat poison and select mundane ailments.
Master Tracker	Locate Animals or Plants	Find wildlife or plants by reading their signs.
Ghostwalk	Pass without Trace	Guide allies through concealment without leaving signs.
Antitoxin Expertise	Protection from Poison	Use prepared remedies to counter toxins.
Killing Ground	Spike Growth	Prepare hidden stakes, caltrops, and snares.

Rank 2 special rules

Battle Hardened requires communication with its recipients. Beast Courier requires an available animal and a reachable destination. Beast Bond works only with an animal bonded during a Long Rest. Danger Sense requires plausible clues and cannot see through walls. Wilderness Medicine requires a healer's kit; it does not remove curses, magical paralysis, or supernatural disease. Master Tracker requires signs in the environment. Ghostwalk requires the Ranger to guide companions within 30 feet. Killing Ground takes 1 minute to prepare, needs a suitable surface, and its physical hazards remain until cleared.

Rank 3 Arts

Ranger Art	Based on	What it looks like
Arrowstorm	Conjure Barrage	Fire a devastating spread of prepared missiles.
Untraceable	Nondetection	Erase tracks, scent, and identifying traces.
Elemental Conditioning	Protection from Energy	Prepare against acid, cold, or fire with equipment and treatments.

Rank 3 special rules

Arrowstorm requires a ranged weapon and ammunition; it cannot hit targets behind total cover. Untraceable replaces the original spell's magical protection: gain Advantage on checks made to avoid mundane tracking, but it does not stop divination. Elemental Conditioning can provide resistance only to Acid, Cold, or Fire damage and requires appropriate preparations.

General limitations

• An Art cannot conjure tools, medicine, ammunition, animals, or terrain from nothing.

• Physical restrictions matter: a disarmed Ranger cannot use a weapon Art; a restrained Ranger cannot use an Art requiring free movement.

• The GM decides whether an unusual environment provides the materials or conditions an Art requires.

• An Art's description is what onlookers perceive. No Art produces glowing runes, spoken incantations, or visible spell energy.

Arts not available

The following traditional spells are not Ranger Arts in Blackhearts. They are intentionally excluded because they conjure or transform matter, manipulate obvious magical forces, or perform effects that cannot reasonably be expressed as fieldcraft or preternatural instinct.

Rank 1: Detect Magic, Entangle, Fog Cloud, Goodberry.

Rank 2: Barkskin, Cordon of Arrows, Gust of Wind, Locate Object, Magic Weapon, Silence, Summon Beast.

Rank 3: Conjure Animals, Daylight, Dispel Magic, Elemental Weapon, Lightning Arrow, Meld into Stone, Plant Growth, Revivify, Speak with Plants, Summon Fey, Water Breathing, Water Walk, Wind Wall.

A note on character portrayal

Your Ranger may consider these Arts disciplined technique, the gift of the wild, inherited instinct, or something more troubling. Ordinary folk might admire the results—until they witness something that should not be possible. Whether the Ranger truly possesses magic is a question the world of Blackhearts may never answer.

Rules note: This is a Blackhearts homebrew replacement for selected 2024 Ranger spells, not an official D&D spell list. When an Art's modified description conflicts with its source spell, the modification takes precedence.